

BOB INGRAM

Out-of-town press gets red carpet



BILL JOHNSON

A LONG BLACK limousine pulled up at International Airport whenever an out-of-town press boxer arrived to cover the 42nd annual Sun Bowl football game.

Bill Johnson, sports information director of the Sun Bowl, and Rich McCarty and his press host committee transported the writers to their downtown hotel in the limousine which looked like it was fresh from a funeral.

Despite such a bizarre welcome, the 46 visiting writers found that it was the season to be jolly. They were so well taken care of here that all of them left with words of praise for the treatment they received during their stay in El Paso.

Jack Hairston of the Gainesville, Fla., Sun, the home newspaper of University of Florida, said: "I've covered every bowl there is with the exception of the Rose, and I've never seen anything as well organized as the group you have here."

The writers were transported from their hotel to various Sun Bowl events, including the game, and back in an English-styled double decker bus borrowed from Radio Station XERO here.

They had their hotel reservations arranged. They headquartered at a hospitality room equipped with a bar and were not only surfeited with liquid refreshments but food as well.

They were taken on tours to Juarez and in El Paso.

A host committeeman even fetched some chewing tobacco for a writer who went to the game without any. The committee also arranged to ship one writer a case of his favorite Tecate beer from Juarez.

2 Andy Cohens

ANDY COHEN, a sports writer of the Jacksonville, Fla., Times-Union, was one of the visiting press boxers.

He may or may not have known until he came to El Paso that this city is the home of Andy Cohen, the town's most revered baseball figure.

Andy Cohen wrote a column about Andy Cohen for the Florida newspaper.

Bill McGrotha is a writer for the Tallahassee, Fla., Democrat. He had

twice made the trip to the Sun Bowl, both times when Florida State played here.

He came to the Jan. 2 Sun Bowl game to cover the University of Florida. He enjoyed his first two visits to El Paso. He was impressed with the expanded hospital of the press committee.

As did some of the other Texas writers, John Hollis of The Houston Post covered other bowls before coming to El Paso. He had an assignment at the Houston Astro-Bluebonnet bowl two days before the Sun Bowl.

Jack Lindberg of The Kansas City Star who was here when Kansas played Pittsburgh didn't make it this time. But he sent his respects to the press committee, saying the Big Eight Conference never took care of the writers as professionally as did the Sun Bowl.

Squeeze job

BILL JOHNSON had to find seats in the press box for 25 Texas and New Mexico writers and 21 from Florida in addition to spaces for the El Paso press. He squeezed everyone in somehow with a minimum amount of discomfort.

The Juarez Race Track and Sunland Park were choice visiting spots for the Texas writers since this state doesn't have parimutuel betting.

Florida writers, used to seeing the horses and dogs run, opted for other tours than the race tracks.

The major complaint of the visiting press boxers was that they didn't have much writing time. Since they were employed mainly to keep their fans back home informed of the Sun Bowl teams, they had to tear themselves away from their entertainment schedule and file some stories.

A separate committee hosted the two CBS broadcasters, Pat Summerall and Tom Brookshier. It was headed by Jimmy Rogers, an old hand at entertaining notables at the Sun Bowl. The two top goldy throats of CBS football broadcasting were royally entertained no doubt and left El Paso with kind thoughts along with perhaps a few saddle sores from riding horses in the Sun Bowl parade.